

SUNBURST

The Newsletter for Seniors United Now

Sherwood Business Center – Park Centre Hotel

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The Voice of Seniors in Alberta

Requests for Advocacy Increase

Financial, Transportation, Abuse, and Housing

are some of the appeals SUN has received over the past few weeks. Has the lack of an Alberta Independent Seniors' Advocate office resulted in this dramatic increase? The increase in requests to SUN for support, guidance and action on individual advocacy is alarming.

As fall has approached and SUN chapters return to regular meetings & SUN administration office returns to regular hours our ability to reply and assist members and non-members with advocacy requests is more consistent. Our advocacy volunteers work hard to find answers to the unique and individual requests that we receive.

This work cannot happen without the support of our membership. SUN needs to increase our membership to continue being a viable resource and advocate for Alberta seniors. See page 14 New membership drive.

Please renew your membership, support our fundraising, donate and consider sharing our information with other seniors in your community.

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Presidents Report

It certainly has been a challenge for most of us to carry out our activities during the poor air quality (smoke) caused by forest fires. Our thoughts go out to the people that lost their home and businesses because of fires and hope that they can recover from this devastating event, especially the residents of Jasper.

Our SUN staff and volunteers were very successful in organizing the April 24th Annual General Meeting. Everyone enjoyed information, food and the entertainment provided by both Terry Mack with Peaceful Spirit Flutes and "The Wild Rose Old Tyme Fiddler Association".

This fall, the SUN Board will follow up on the government review of the seniors out of pocket cost for having a cognitive test done by a medical practitioner, to retain their current vehicle driver's license. We are looking for the elimination of these costs or at least a reduction, but to date have not received a reply from the Hon. Adriana LaGrange, Health Minister.

As indicated in my last report, we were very pleased that the Local Authorities Pension Plan (LAPP) granted retirees an increase to 100% Cost of Living Adjustment for the 2024 calendar year and a review to see if they can continue this increase into the future.

However, when I travelled within Alberta I spoke to numerous LAPP retirees, nurses, municipal government workers and discovered that some of them were not aware of SUN's involvement and input which resulted in LAPP's Board of Directors making this positive decision.

At our upcoming SUN Board meetings, we will discuss developing a successful plan to increase our membership so that we can continue to be an effective non-profit society and the voice of seniors.

We have several retirees that belong to the Alberta Public Service Pension Plan and that plan only provides 60% of the Cost-of-Living Adjustment. We will be communicating with appropriate MLA's and pension Board Members to suggest a COLA increase to 100% of the Alberta Consumer Price Index.

We are aware that early this fall the Alberta government will once again be discussing their proposed Alberta Pension Plan. It will be interesting to see if the government discloses how many Albertans are in favor of the proposed plan. In the APP proposed legislation, they indicated they will grant 100% COLA for retirees, the same as what the Canada Pension Plan provides. However, it is important to note that currently the Alberta Government only provides 60% of COLA for their retired employees who contributed to the Alberta Public Service Plan. As you can see, we have our work cut out for us, but we will continue to seek fairness in pension plans.

Through the summer months, our Chapters have been busy lining up guest speakers for their fall meetings, and I encourage you to attend and bring a friend and enjoy the informative and friendly atmosphere.

Sincerely,
Wayne Sorenson, President

Executive Director Report

Fall is now upon us, and I hope you had a very pleasant summer. The Chapters are resuming meetings in September and they have some very interesting guest speakers. We hope to continue offering a zoom meeting every few months as we did last year.

I have continued to attend meetings with Public Interest Alberta (PIA) Seniors Task Force, and other senior organizations to keep informed on issues that matter to our seniors. This fall we will be doing presentations to senior groups that have expressed interested in joining Seniors United Now.

I hope that you will continue to support SUN, we are looking forward to continue advocating for our members in this province.

Respectfully submitted,

Linda Osborne sunexdir@telus.net 780-920-3058

South Edmonton Chapter**A message to our chapter members**

Meetings of South Edmonton Chapter are held at the Whitemud Public Library (4211 -106 St.) in the Program Room. Registration is now at 1:45 pm and the presentation is at 2:15 pm. We wish to thank the library and its staff for the support we received during the past year. Also, we thank McDonalds 23rd Ave & 110th St for the complimentary coffee and snacks provided for each meeting.

Everyone is welcomed at our meetings, member or non-member.

If you are interested in joining SUN and our chapter executive, please contact us.

This would involve helping at our events and attending our executive meetings, which are usually held monthly. Contact information is below.



Our meetings for the fall will be on the third Friday of the month with no December presentation.

WHAT HAPPENED...

May 17, 2024 Thalia Hartson from the River Stone Wellness Centre spoke on the topic, Nurse Practitioners: Their Role and Services Within Alberta Health Care. There are a wide range of services provided at the centre, but it was not clear what payments would be covered by Alberta Health Services.

June 21, 2024 Shannon Saunders, Health Educator. Alberta Health Services- Continuing Care, Edmonton Zone spoke on the topic, Continuing Care – Edmonton Zone. It was an excellent presentation dealing with eligibility for programs, types of care such as home and community, types A and B continuing care, and palliative care.

September 20, 2024 Nancy Wang from the Seniors Outreach Program spoke on how seniors can contact various organizations in Edmonton to receive information about relevant services and programs. There are ten organizations that can refer older adults to services such as financial assistance, help with forms, home care, housing, social groups, housekeeping, snow removal, yardwork, moving help and health issues. Seniors can call 211 and press 2 for the Seniors Information phone line, walk into any of the ten agencies or visit: [Seniors Home Supports Program - Home](#) This was an excellent presentation with valuable handouts containing vital information.

WHAT'S UPCOMING...

October 18, 2024 Denise Roy-Popal - Community Support Manager from the Greater Edmonton Foundation(GEF) for Senior Housing, will speak on the following topic: Getting to Know – GEF. She will explain who they are, what they do, the type of accommodation offered, and contact information. What locations we can offer, How do we determine eligibility? What is the application process? What are the wait times? What are the rental rates and fees?

November 15, 2024 To Be Confirmed

Reminder: registration, as noted above, will start at 1:45 pm and the presentations will begin at 2:15 pm.

Chair: Robert Price

780-250-7164 rogp@shaw.ca



Hard working SUN Volunteers at Registration



Terry Mack - Peaceful Spirit Flutes

SUN ED Linda with 50/50 winner Betty N

Annual General Meeting April 2024

The 2024 AGM was successfully held, and all required business was concluded. SUN Board Member Carolyn Reed, who is leaving the Board, was recognized for her years of service.

SUN thanks the many volunteers that ensured the AGM went smoothly, Gloria G, Marg, Elsie, Deirdre, Denis, and Cynthia. Thanks also to the volunteer Board members: Wayne, Stan, Gloria, Bob, Rita, Frances, and William for their work before, during and after the AGM. SUN also acknowledges the efforts of staff, Linda, Deborah and Lynn.

SUN Annual General Meeting had a few sponsors we would like to acknowledge: Home Care By Angels, Eazy Peazy Downsizing and Melody Hearing Clinic. Another exhibitor was Pallaval Kambo with City of Edmonton on the ARC card.

Attendees were welcomed to the meeting room with the wonderful music from Terry Mack with Peaceful Spirit Flutes.

Approximately Ninety individuals attended, and members comments generally were excellent food, service, and location. After the business concluded we were entertained by the Wild Rose Old Tyme Fiddlers. They were very well received with our members toe tapping and singing along to the songs.

SUN has booked Santa Maria Goretti for April 16, 2025. Hope you will join us.



April 24 2024 SUN Annual General Meeting

Wild Rose Fiddlers Perform at SUN AGM 2024

Giving Thanks Notable Quotes

"As we express our gratitude, we must never forget that the highest appreciation is not to utter words, but to live by them. We must learn the lessons taught by the mistakes of others. We must recognize our own shortcomings."
John F. Kennedy

"Be grateful for what you already have while you pursue your goals. If you aren't grateful for what you already have, what makes you think you would be happy with more."
Roy T. Bennett

"Cultivate the habit of being grateful for every good thing that comes to you, and to give thanks continuously. And because all things have contributed to your advancement, you should include all things in your gratitude."
Ralph Waldo Emerson

"Love and kindness are never wasted. They always make a difference. They bless the one who receives them, and they bless you, the giver."
Barbara De Angelis



SUN Executive Team Wayne Sorenson - Pres. Stan Poznanski - VP Gloria Krenbrenk - Sect. William Holtz - Tres.

SUN Board of Directors 2024 – 2025

Wayne Sorenson - President Stan Poznanski - Vice-President William Holtz - Treasurer
Gloria Krenbrenk - Secretary Robert Price - Director Gerald Northam - Director
Frances Burkitt - Director Rita DeLongchamp-Osborne - Director

SUN Staff

Linda Osborne - Executive Director Lynn Penner - Office Admin Deborah Wilson - Membership Coordinator



Thanksgiving is all about gratitude, so we want to say that we are grateful for you, our members. Wishing you all the warmth of family, friends and a heart full of gratitude this holiday.



North Edmonton Chapter**Quarterly Activity Summary**

We continue to hold our meetings at Glengarry Community Hall, 13325 – 89 street, Edmonton. Registration begins at 1:00 p.m. and the meeting commences at 1:30 p.m. Our volunteers continue to step forward to arrange the seating requirements as well as the post meeting clean up requirements. If you have some computer skills, please step forward as we need a recording secretary. If you can help, contact Wayne Sorenson at 780-964-1142.

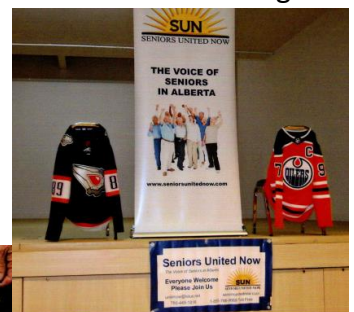
At each meeting, we host excellent guest speakers who discuss a variety of seniors topics. At the end of each meeting, we have a Save on Foods gift card door prize and a 50/50 draw. Everyone is welcome, bring a friend and enjoy the fellowship, free baked goods and tea and coffee. A very special thank you to Save on Foods located at 167 Ave. and 50th street for their donation of tasty treats for our meetings.

**WHATS HAPPENED?**

April 18, 2024 Jollean Ferrari, representing the North East Seniors Association presented a power point presentation on the services that are made available to seniors. She made available their newly printed up to date booklet outlining the services they provide.

May 9, 2024 Nicole Skiba owner of Easy Peazy Downsizing took us through the steps needed when downsizing and relocating. Included were stories, lessons learned, and practical advice on getting the job done and achieving the lifestyle you desire. Everyone enjoyed her presentation!

June 13, 2024 In keeping with tradition, our chapter sponsored a Chapter Seniors United Now members appreciation day. Our members enjoyed the free luncheon, the Edmonton Oilers decorations and the Oilers Good Luck cake. They enjoyed themselves socializing with fellow members and shared their thoughts and ideas for future guest speaker topics as well as senior concerns that they would like to see addressed.



September 12, 2024 Guest speakers Sharon Spandza and Cheryl McCarron from Chartwell Griesbach Retirement Community, discussed the types and various stages of Dementia, and the care provided their residents. The presentation was well received by 40 attendees and handout materials were provided.

WHATS UPCOMING?

October 10, 2024 Justin Kumar and Karalynn Tran will conduct a presentation on Identity Theft and Fraud Prevention and contributing to the enhancement of financial literacy within our community.

November 14, 2024 Presenters scheduled through the United Way, will empower participants by improving financial security through saving and asset management and increasing access and awareness to safe, affordable financial products and services.

Wayne Sorenson – Chair, North Edmonton Chapter
wm.s1@telus.net 780-964-1142



RESEARCH STUDY

OLDER MEN NEEDED

(age 65 years +)



Defining and prioritizing modifiable risk factors towards the co-creation of a urinary incontinence intervention for older men: A two-tier healthcare professionals' consensus study and older men's survey

- Take a short quiz to know if you can participate
- Complete the study questionnaire, if you are eligible
- No responses will be identified to you, so you can be assured of privacy and confidentiality.

Urinary incontinence (UI), which is the accidental leakage of urine, is not part of the normal aging process and can be managed using different approaches.

By taking part in our research, you help us to understand the factors that older men feel capable and willing to change.

This knowledge enables us to partner with you in developing a self-help tool for symptom control and UI-related quality of life improvement.

Your participation will take
approximately 5 minutes



You will receive a **\$15**
gift card for your time



Please take the survey by scanning the QR code, or contact us if you prefer paper questionnaires.

PLEASE CONTACT

Adrian Wagg
wagg@ualberta.ca

Olawunmi Olagundoye
olagundo@ualberta.ca
© 780 974 6036



Ethics ID: Pro00134937

Sherwood Park / Strathcona County Chapter (SPSC)

Quarterly Activity Summary

Chapter meetings are held on the 3rd Tuesday of each month except April, July, August, and December. Registration at 1:00p.m. Meetings commence at 1:30pm and are held at Bethel Lutheran Church located at 298 Bethel Drive, Sherwood Park, which is fully accessible. Members and non-members are welcome. Our presenters answer many questions during and after their presentations and are thanked with an appreciation gift. ***A special thank you to the Sherwood Park Real Canadian Superstore for supplying us for cookies & Funky Petals, Sherwood Park, owner Laurie T. for her donation of door prizes.***



What's Happened? Lots!!

May 21- Chapter meeting - Topic: Mayor Rod Frank, was asked to present us with: "His vision for the County and How seniors fit into that vision". Mayor Frank spent much of his presentation outlining the programs, resources and supports that the county is presently providing for Seniors in the county. Recreational opportunities are the biggest way that the county is currently supporting seniors. Social programs such as the 55+ club and other clubs throughout the county meet the needs of many seniors. Other supportive programs for seniors with chronic ailments such as Parkinsons and Alzheimer's are also available. Outdoor programs, cultural programs and presently supports for seniors who would like to say in their own homes are a priority. Financial supports, affordable transportation, WeSeniors engagement are all ways that the county is trying to help seniors. The County is presently conducting a survey to see how older adults can be further helped by building a new senior center and what that entails. The mayor fielded many questions surrounding a new seniors centre and many welcomed the opportunity to engage personally with the mayor.

June 4 - Seniors Day Celebration - AGORA – hosted by the WESeniors. Volunteers from SUN and our ASSC committee volunteered at the SUN booth at this event. The turnout was very good. Many participants were interested in a Seniors Center, a lot of good connections were made, and we received encouragement for the project at hand.

June 10 - Councillor Robert Parks, Ward 1 - about 30 people present **June 24** - Councillor Corey-Ann Harwick- ward 6 - about 30 people present

June 18 - Chapter meeting - Topic: - Strathcona County Garden Club- Presenter: Donna Reimche - **Growing Vegetables Outside of the Regular Fare-** Presenter: Lori Hawrelak

Donna presented her experience of gardening over the years. Delights of watching things grow included such things as giant poppies, harvesting the seeds and using her mother's recipe to make poppy seed cake. Heritage tomatoes that came from seeds that can be traced back to the early 1900's when a Russian immigrant stowed those few previous seeds in her clothing as she travelled to live in Canada made gardening into a story. She gave us many insights into why some things fail to grow including bad soil, pollination failure, drought conditions or just plain bad luck.

Lori did a presentation on the Strathcona County Garden Club. Their mission is to foster an interest in and an understanding and enjoyment of gardening among members and the community through a variety of activities. It provides a forum for the consideration and discussion of questions affecting the interests of the Club and acts as a lobby or support group on issues relating to the Club's interests. They have monthly meetings, a newsletter, seed and plant exchanges, sales, field trips and gardening plots available at Old Man Creek. They have a membership of 160+ members with both novice and seasoned gardeners and can be reached at strathconacountygardenclub.ca

Normally our chapter executive is off on vacation for July and August, but the ASSC (Advocacy for Strathcona Seniors Centre) Committee has been very active and continues to work for you.

June 10 - Councillor Robert Parks, Ward 1 - about 30 people present **June 24** - Councillor Corey-Ann Harwick- ward 6 - about 30 people present

July 09 - Council Meeting – Family Community Services (FCS) presented the results of the Older Adult Survey done in Strathcona County to the public. Over forty seniors were present at the meeting.

July 12 - Family Community Services (FCS) - Attendees discussed the results of the **Older Adult Survey** put out by the County. Six members of our committee attended this meeting. The results indicated the overwhelming support for a new centre in Sherwood Park. Another surprising result was that many seniors indicated that they weren't sure if they would use such a facility. This could be simply explained by the fact that many seniors in the county have never experienced such a facility or that as seniors age and their needs increase this facility may become more of a priority for them.

July 17 - Councillors Aaron Nelson, Ward 5 and Glen Lawrence, Ward 7 - about 25 people present

Sherwood Park / Strathcona County Chapter (SPSC)**Continued from Page 8**

August 02 - your committee toured both the St. Albert Seniors' Centre and the West End Seniors Activity Centre. Much information was gathered from both tours. We met with both executive directors and asked many questions about how the centres were run and how they received funding. We saw many differences in the two centres. We left with unanswered questions which are forcing us to look deeply into our own situation in Strathcona County and how we should best proceed.

August 22 - The ASSC committee visited the Northeast Seniors Centre (NESA) and Lions Central Seniors Centre. Much information was gathered on how these seniors' centres were run on how the physical space was organized, how they were financed, and what grants they were able to obtain and from what sources.

August 23 - Four members of the ASSC Committee participated in the Family Community Services Meeting regarding how affordability impacts different groups of older adults. Senior representatives from the county including CFS members were brought together to see how best seniors can be supported by the county when dealing with food security, affordable housing, transportation, social isolation and generally the cost of living. A seniors' centre could provide a central hub from which some of these issues could be addressed.

September 6 - Josephburg Seniors Centre – The Executive met with us and are supporting us in our endeavour to have a Seniors Centre here in Sherwood Park. They are working closely with WESeniors, who are providing great programming for them, and they do not wish to lose this resource, as their membership is increasing because of this support.

South Cooking Lake Seniors Centre - Met with Karen Johnston, who is trying to engage seniors in the area to join the Seniors Centre but is having challenges getting people involved.

September 13 – Met with 55+ Club, treasurer secretary, and president, Ray McCartney, who toured us around their place. We would love to have them come on board and join us in our quest for an updated Seniors Centre.

September 17- Chapter meeting - Topic: MLA Kyle Kasawski – A well-attended meeting with 45+ present. Kyle gave us a brief overview of who he was and his approach to politics. A question-and-answer session followed that broached many topics including but not limited to public healthcare and how do we attract more doctors and nurses, basic issues such as insurance and grocery stores. It was brought to our attention that the government has stopped reporting stats in certain areas, and this may not be helping. Other areas of concern involved the Canada Pension Plan, The RCMP and alternative policing, cancelation of the Super lab for medical testing, affordable housing and the failure of the free market to provide adequate accommodations for all. Mr. Kasawski was thanked for answering all our questions and was presented with an umbrella to shield himself from some of the abuse he is likely to take as the legislature officially opens to the fall session.

September 18 - A very positive meeting with Riley Tookey from the Men's Shed

September 19 – Sophie Homeniuk Ardrossan Seniors Centre.

What's Upcoming?

Marianne West has compiled all the information from all seniors' centres, which we plan to present to Council at a Priorities Meeting in October. Next step - We plan to meet with Councillors from Wards 1, 2 & 3 (Robert Parks, Dave Anderson & Lorne Harvey) as soon as possible. We want to inform them of what we have accomplished during the summer and ask for updates on what is happening Council-wise re our Seniors Centre in Sherwood Park.

October 15, 2024 - Topic: TBA

Nov 19, 2024 - Topic: TBA

Speaker: Strathcona County - Solutions Navigation and Social Supports



SUN continues to work for you.

Report respectfully submitted by: Denis Beaudry
Chairperson, SPSC Chapter

Join us!

We welcome your wisdom, experience, and enthusiasm!



How scammers use artificial intelligence

Sadly, the rise of artificial intelligence (AI) has exacerbated frauds of all kinds. While anyone can fall prey to technology-enabled schemes to separate them from their money, seniors need to pay particular attention, according to credit reporting agency [Equifax](#), fraud is now the top crime perpetrated against older Canadians. Sadly, many seniors fail to report these crimes to the police because they feel shame or embarrassment about being duped by scam artists. So, the impact is higher than we even realize. Frauds can be conducted by telephone, email, texting on phones and via social media, not to mention the old-fashioned knock on a homeowner's door.

The IA twist to the grandparent scam has added what many believe is the voice of their loved one, usually a grandchild. Their grandchild had called and said they were in an accident or are in trouble. The imposter knows some personal details about the actual grandchildren, like where they live and work, and the names of other family members.

There have been reports of similar scams happening across Canada, with police believing a criminal network is responsible for targeting seniors from coast to coast. Fraudsters often have a lot of personal information about victims gathered from social media and other open sources. Victims have sworn it was their grandchild's voice, but how is it possible for them to replicate actual voices? Turns out it's quite easy, cheap and effective. You can clone someone's voice, and given the ability to do that, it's not at all surprising that somebody would do that for nefarious purposes. Fraudsters scour social media to find people online, if there's a video or any kind of audio on that social media, then they're using AI to mimic that individual. The next step is to track down their grandparents and begin the scam.

Prevent yourself from being victimized

The tool that the fraudsters use is panic. They get the targeted victim upset, get them worried about their loved ones, and then have them rush around, trying to gather money. The best thing to do is tell the caller you will get back to them, find your loved one's number and phone them directly to confirm the circumstances. Do not call the fraudster back on a number that they provide, claiming they are using a friends phone, as they have lost their own phone, their battery is dead or any other reason to contact them on a number they provide.

Fraudsters will try to make it sound like the victim has no control, but the people receiving the phone calls should know that they are in control and can call their family to find out what's really going on.

Our next Cash Raffle is: "Halloween Hoot"

October 31, 2024
License #700801



Join our growing list of SUN winners! See page 15 for ticket order form or purchase online: www.seniorsunitednow.com

Tickets \$5.00 each 5 Tickets \$10.00 20 tickets \$20.00
Please consider supporting SUN's critical fundraising.

CASH RAFFLE – Winners "Frog Jumping Day"

May 13, 2024
License #682716

Congratulations to SUN members:

D. Quartly Stony Plain, AB ticket #167
L. Solaczek Calgary, AB Ticket #608

**Thanks to all members for supporting SUN's
critical fundraising by purchasing tickets!**



SENIORS' MEDICATION WOES

There is much talk about the need for a National pharmacare plan to help seniors access and pay for prescriptions. Which of course would be helpful, but as seniors age (to state the obvious), they have recurring medical issues that have to be treated through intervention by doctors and other medical experts. These ailments, many minor but nagging, aren't always solved by doctors' prescriptions as seniors must buy a whole range of over-the-counter medications. Often these medicines are the bane for seniors, including me, for several reasons.

First, is their high cost, which are usually not covered by prescription plans and Medicare. Yet doctors recommend that their patients purchase these products. For me, a good example recently was after I had a biopsy for a skin growth on my foot. The doctor instructed me to buy an antiseptic cream to use on the foot before applying a bandage, and then change the dressing daily for about a week. I bought this cream in an extremely small 15-gram tube for about \$9. Right now, I am using three different ointments for my feet. Shouldn't there be a brand that could cover all three ailments to reduce the costs, or am I just dreaming? Prices are also high for other drugs such as cold, flu and pain medication, which I often need. Also, after using some of the drugs, most of the pills remained unused for some time. By the time I need to use them again, they pass the expiry date, at least according to the pills' drug makers.

Second, with so many some over the counter medicines, a senior or just anybody has a hard time choosing which ones to buy. They don't always work the same, and some work against each other or against one's regular prescription medication, creating uncertainty over their effectiveness and worry about side effects. Let's consider over the counter laxative pills and powders, often highly recommended by doctors and pharmacists. Incontinence is one major issue faced by seniors. Again, the market is loaded with expensive laxatives – pills and powder so a senior might have difficulty in making a choice of what to buy. Sometimes it's often experimental, which can increase the overall costs. All of course, being over the counter, are paid for by the patient. One unnamed product cost is \$15 for a bottle of 119 grams, about seven doses, but instructions are vague on what one dose is. My pharmacist suggests that I take one dose in a glass of water every day. That means buying at least 4 bottles a month for a total of \$60. Assume that in a 31-day month, I take three days off from this routine (following the old Julian calendar). Multiply that price by 12 and it comes to a whopping \$720. That's before one even invests in other medication for colds and pain, or for foot issues. Maybe we need an over-the-counter payment plan drugs?

Finally, let's look at side effects of the unnamed drug mentioned earlier. This one laxative drug lists the following: Don't take if you have a fever, nausea, vomiting, abdominal pain, are pregnant or thinking about becoming pregnant, or are breast-feeding (the last three not senior issues hopefully!). Also don't take if you have bowel obstruction, (which might be an obvious reason), have kidney disease, are allergic to some of the ingredients (which you might not realize until after using it), or have an interaction to other drugs you are taking. Then they state not to take it if you have any medical issues. Imagine! Seniors having medical issues! Ever notice that high blood pressure is usually included in the list of side effects for some drugs. How many seniors have high blood pressure? Also, because I'm taking a blood thinner, many drugs are taboo. Makes me wonder what I could take with all the different pills in my health regime. Also, you must have seen all those ads on TV which try to sell you certain drugs followed by a long list of side effects. Maybe those happy faces portrayed in the commercials should turn to frowns?

In conclusion, I guess the pharmaceutical companies are there to make money. Maybe we need over the counter payment plans for these drugs, but too many profits would be lost. In addition, they must list every side effect they can come up with to avoid any possible lawsuits. Do seniors have time, money and energy to launch lawsuits?

Submitted by Robert Price

Say hello to exclusive savings on car and home insurance through belairdirect.

This past fall, Johnson Insurance began an exciting rebranding transformation, evolving into belairdirect while preserving all the ingredients and history that made this brand so well-respected. Under the belairdirect brand, you will continue to have access to exclusive offers and coverage, ensuring that insurance is one less thing for you and your family to worry about.

We understand that you require coverage that makes your life easier. Fortunately, belairdirect has you covered.

As a member of Seniors United Now, our tailored insurance deals are designed to simplify the insurance process for you, providing convenience and peace of mind.

You'll also enjoy enhanced home coverage and the option for great car insurance add-ons with their Affinity Plus endorsement. Plus, a suite of helpful digital tools that make managing your insurance a breeze!

Get your quote today with group ID code ASUNS

Visit belairdirect.com/healthcare or call 1-833-887-4626

**Message from your Membership Coordinator**

Membership is the only way SUN has to fund the programs and materials we provide for our members. It is a very **important** aspect of running our advocacy program. If we are to continue to be the Voice of Seniors in Alberta, we need you to renew your memberships, invite your friends to our Chapter meetings, purchase our 50/50 tickets and of course volunteer and support our events.

We have a Facebook page now which could be used to recruit new members. If you have a facebook page search Seniors United Now and join our page, invite your friends. We post Chapter Meetings, AGM information, guest speakers and newsletter updates. Consider finding our page.

If you have any ideas on how to increase our membership, I would be open to hearing from you. You can reach me by email at suncoord@telus.net. Chapters need your support to keep running so consider volunteering at their meetings. Membership has its rewards with benefits of new friendships, check out our website at www.seniorsunitednow.com for information and support.

I look forward to working for you for a better SUN.

Deborah Wilson, Membership Coordinator





Deborah Wilson - Membership Coord & Linda Osborne Ex Dir at Volunteer Fair

FRIENDLY CALLS

What if we told you that a meaningful connection was just a *phone call* away?



Make a connection, one call at a time.

Friendly Calls is **safe, accessible, free, and available nationwide.**
Call 1-833-979-9779 or connect with us at redcross.ca/friendlycalls.

The Friendly Calls program matches **people over the age of 18** with trained Red Cross personnel who connect with them regularly to check-in, provide emotional support, encourage healthy coping strategies, and suggest well-being resources and community connections to other existing services.



Communications – Advocacy – Pensions

Excerpt from letter of Sept 4, 2024 Subject: Cost of Living is U.C.P's Top Priority

To: Danielle Smith - Alberta Premier Jason Nixon - Seniors Minister Nate Horner - Minister of Treasury
David Lardner - PSPP Board of Directors and C.E.O Nathan Neudorf - Minister of Affordability and Utilities
Naheed Nenshi - Leader of the Official Opposition

We are encouraged when we read the June 12, 2024 Edmonton Journal article written by the Hon. Nathan Neudorf, Minister of Affordability and Utilities. He states, "Addressing the cost of living is a top priority for the UCP Government". To see the results of the Affordability Action Plan is quite an accomplishment which included protecting and supporting vulnerable Albertans, including Seniors and indexing financial benefits like AISH and other Social Programs.

Your Affordability Action plan will assist many Albertans in maintaining their livelihood during these inflationary times.

SUN has recently conducted a review of Cost-of-Living Adjustment Standards that relate to a number of pension plans. The results indicate that the Local Authority Pension Plan provides 100% COLA to their retirees as well as the Canada Pension Plan. Reviewing the proposed legislation for the proposed Alberta Pension Plan also confirms that 100% of COLA would also be provided.

Unfortunately, the Public Service Pension Plan for many decades only provides 60% COLA to their retirees, while at this point in time the plan currently has a surplus of 4.54 billion-dollar surplus. Because of this deficiency over many decades these retirees have seen their livelihood diminish to the point of creating undue hardship. These Public Service employees (now retirees) worked under many different Governments during their working years, such as Social Credit, Conservative, N.D.P. and the current U.C.P. They were the ones that greased the wheels of Government that helped make Alberta the Province that it is today.

We do know that the Public Service Pension Plan retirees are questioning, why would the proposed Alberta Pension Plan provide 100% COLA and the PSPP only provides 60%. It is a good question, and it needs to be addressed.

We are requesting an opportunity to meet with you to discuss the importance of providing 100% COLA for the Public Service Pension Plan retired members.

Wayne Sorenson President – Seniors United Now

Membership Drive

We need to reach out and engage more seniors and we need your help to do this. You, our members are what keep SUN vital and productive. What can you do? Volunteer if you are able, keep your membership current, donate if you can and encourage other seniors to join and become SUN members. How can you get others to join? SUN is offering every current SUN member the opportunity to gift a FREE 6-month membership to another senior. How do you do this? Complete the Membership gift form and send it to the SUN admin office and we will do all the rest. Every current SUN member that completes a gift membership to a NEW SUN Member will be entered into a draw for a SUN Prize. SUN Administration #37 2016 Sherwood Drive, Sherwood Park, Ab T8A 3X3 (or email the information with * SUN Gift Membership* in the subject line) unitenow@telus.net

SUN MEMBERSHIP GIFT valid – October – December 2024

Gift Memberships will be due for renewal June 2025

Current Member Name: _____ **Membership#** _____

Gift Membership details:

Name(s): _____

Address: _____

Phone # _____ **Email** _____

Year of Birth: _____ **If available (used for SUN demographics only will not be shared)** **For Office USE:** _____



Halloween Funnies

- 1: What do you call a dancing ghost?
- 2: When do ghouls and goblins cook their victims?
- 3: How do you write a book about Halloween?
- 4: Where does Count Dracula usually eat his lunch?
- 5: Why do vampires need mouthwash?
- 6: What is a vampire's favorite holiday?
- 7: What did one ghost say to the other ghost?
- 8: What do you get when you cross Bambi with a ghost?
- 9: What's a ghost's favorite ride at the carnival?
- 10: When does a ghost have breakfast?
- 11: What do you call a ghost with a broken leg?
- 12: What did the skeleton say to the vampire?
- 13: What is a Skeleton's favorite song?
- 14: What's a zombie's favorite bean?
- 15: Do zombies eat popcorn with their fingers?



1A: Polka-haunt-us.
2A: On Fry Day
3A: With a ghostwriter
4A: At the casketeria
5A: They have bat breath
6A: Fangsgiving
7A: "Do you believe in people?"
8A: Bamboo
9A: The roller ghoster
10A: In the moaning
11A: Hoblin' Goblin
12A: You suck
13A: Bad to the Bone
14A: A human bean
15A: No, they eat the fingers separately

Halloween Funnies answers

Halloween Hoot

Name(s): _____

Address: _____

Phone # _____ For Office USE: _____

Email _____
(please print)

Individual Tickets: _____ Tickets \$5.00 each \$ _____ (40 available)

5 tickets \$10.00 _____ Sets \$10.00 each \$ _____ (60 sets available)

20 tickets \$20.00 _____ Sets \$20.00 each \$ _____ (110 sets available)

Draw Date: October 31, 2024**License #700801****Please make your cheque
payable to SUN****RAFFLE RULES**

- 1) Raffle tickets must not be sold to a person under the age of 18 years. Purchasers must be Alberta residents.
- 2) The purchase price of each ticket shall be: \$5.00 each OR 5 tickets \$10.00 OR 20 tickets \$20.00
- 3) To be eligible for draws, the ticket order and purchase amount must be received in SUN office by 10:00am, OCTOBER 31, 2024
- 4) The prize payout shall be as follows:
1st prize 30% of the gross ticket sale revenue
2nd prize 20% of the gross ticket sale revenue
- 5) The draw(s) shall be made at the SUN office: #37 2016 Sherwood Drive, Sherwood Park, AB T8A3X3 prior to 3pm, October 31, 2024
- 6) The winning ticket buyers shall be notified by telephone; their names will be publicized in the next newsletter & on the SUN website. The winning ticket buyers will be awarded the prize via cheque drawn on SUN.
- 7) In the event of any concern or dispute regarding this raffle, please contact Lynn Penner at the SUN administration office. 780-449-1816
- 8) Raffle tickets are official when payment is received & numbers issued by the sun raffle chairman.
- 9) Your Ticket numbers are available by contacting the SUN office

**SUN MEMBERSHIP Renewal / Donation Sept – Dec 2024**Individual: ☐ \$25 per year ☐ \$50 2 years Lifetime: ☐ \$200Joint: ☐ \$40 per year ☐ \$80 2 years Lifetime: ☐ \$300**Donation in addition to membership dues**☐ \$5 ☐ \$10 ☐ \$15 ☐ \$20 ☐ \$25 ☐ other \$ _____

Renewal \$ _____ Donation \$ _____ Raffle \$ _____

Please make cheque payable to Seniors United Now

Signed Cheque(s) enclosed Chq# _____ Total \$ _____

Membership # _____ (see Back Page)

Joint Member (if applicable) Membership # _____

☐ YES - replace my membership card☐ YES - replace my membership card**(Please attach a stamped self-addressed stamped envelope if you are requesting a replacement card)**

Name: _____

Name: _____

Year of Birth: _____ (used for SUN demographics only)

Year of Birth: _____ (used for SUN demographics only)

Address: _____

(If different from mailing label on reverse)

Renew your membership online! SUN uses the PayPal system, for secure online renewals & donations**Etransfer may also be used for membership payments and donations. unitenow@telus.net**

Phone: _____ Email: _____ (send me electronic SUN information)

(Please print clearly)

☐ YES – I am interested in volunteering, please contact me.

Thank-You for your prompt renewal. Renewals & donations may also be made by Etransfer to unitenow@telus.net or online via our website

LOCAL MUNICIPAL RETIRED EMPLOYEES BENEFIT FROM SUN ACTIONS

Retired County and Municipal Government workers, who contributed to the Local Authority Pension Plan have had their Cost-of-Living Adjustment increased from 60% to 100%, this also includes retired nurses. Some of these workers may not be aware of the increase on their pension cheques, or those that are aware may not understand how this all came about.

Seniors United Now Society held “zoom” meetings and corresponded with the Local Authority Pension Plan Board of Directors. This correspondence can be reviewed on our website - communications tab.

<https://www.seniorsunitednow.com/communications.html>

I am sure that these retirees are pleasantly surprised that the voice of seniors, “SUN” played an important part in bringing about this increase, which they can enjoy spending within their community.

Since 2003, “SUN” has been a leading advocate on behalf of seniors.

Recently some seniors may have noticed a 25% fee reduction when they renewed their driver’s license and vehicle registration. Linda Osborne and Wayne Sorenson met with the Assistant Deputy Minister of Seniors, Dana Mackie, he was filling in for the minister and we discussed SUN’S four priorities health/wellness, seniors’ isolation, financial concerns and transportation. About a week after our meeting, the 25% reduction in registry fees such as driver’s license and vehicle registration renewals were announced. A small step in the right direction.

SUN continues to request face-to-face meetings to be “The Voice of Seniors in Alberta”.

Becoming a member of “SUN” can assist in continuing our advocacy work for your benefit!

Join SUN online <https://www.seniorsunitednow.com/join-or-renew.html>



Alberta Seniors United Now Society (SUN)

WHO ARE WE:

SUN stands for Seniors United Now and is a society registered under the Alberta Societies Act. Seniors United Now is a non-profit, non-partisan organization created on August 27, 2003 to enable all seniors in Alberta to contribute and truly participate in the well-being of the province. Seniors United Now came out of a turbulent and chaotic reaction to the government cutbacks to seniors’ programs in 2003. SUN has evolved into a much broader based, credible and dynamic organization that is a leading resource and advocate for seniors’ issues. SUN is dedicated to ensuring the equitable treatment in the community for seniors by making our collective voices heard. SUN is committed to being a contributing part of the changes necessary to meet the dynamics of a growing and changing senior population. SUN has members located all over Alberta with an active provincial board, an executive director, office manager, and coordinator of membership. SUN has a growing team of volunteers

WHAT CAN WE DO: SUN members realize that the effectiveness of these activities is hugely influenced by the size of our membership. Seniors are in the unique position of having knowledge and experience beyond the ordinary. We have a responsibility to use that knowledge and experience to guide our elected officials and they have a responsibility to listen.

WHAT CAN YOU DO: Become a member, renew your annual membership, talk to your relatives, friends and neighbours, encourage them to become SUN members, **Volunteer your knowledge, talents and experiences!**

Thank-you for being a SUN member, your membership status is available by contacting the SUN Administration office
780-449-1816 unitenow@telus.net



The Voice of Seniors in Alberta

Seniors United Now Society
Sherwood Business Ctr – Park Ctr Hotel
#37 2016 Sherwood Drive
Sherwood Park AB T8A 3X3
unitenow@telus.net
780-449-1816
Toll Free 1-855-786-8669